LEADERSHIP CLASS | NOVEMBER 11

Leadership Is Not What You Think

Bart Paden

EIGHTH GRADE

I got a C in my 8th grade programming class.

Then I decided to build a software company.

1993 | MISSOURI SOUTHERN

Two professors gave me a runway.

No books. No YouTube. I figured it out.

PRECIOUS MOMENTS | 1998

They asked for a press release. I built a website.

I was hired for marketing. The website opened the door.

PRECIOUS MOMENTS, 1998 TO 2003

$20,000 to $1.2 million

Online sales. My salary was $47,000 a year.

BUILT TO 100+ PEOPLE. SOLD IN 2022.

Not bad for a guy who got a C in programming.

Seven figures.

ONE IDEA HELD UP

If you grow people, you grow the organization.

If you use people, you lose it.

ASK THE ROOM

Think of the best leader you have ever had.

What did they do?

ASK THE ROOM

What do you know about being a servant?

ASK THE ROOM

Do you know what servant leadership is?

WHERE THE NAME COMES FROM

“The servant-leader is servant first…”

Robert K. Greenleaf, *The Servant as Leader*, 1970

GREENLEAF'S TEST

Do the people you serve grow?

Healthier. Wiser. More able to stand on their own.

NOT SOFT

The hardest way to lead.

One. Put people ahead of you.

Two. Hold the standard.

MY FIRST HIRE

$200 a month.

What I gave up of my own pay so a young designer could have health insurance for his family.

HOLDING THE STANDARD

$30,000 back.

We lost the project. We kept the relationship.

THE RULE

Take the hit.
Do not take the lesson away.

When your team fails, you own it. The person who caused it still gets to learn.

WHERE I GOT IT WRONG

Not martyrdom. Stewardship.

I ran myself empty trying to carry everyone.

HOW WE RAN IT

We fed the team every week.

Breakfast with me every Friday.

20% of the week for growth, not client work.

MWI CARES

The crying couch.

A brand-new leather couch. Anything said on it was safe.

BACK TO THE BOARD

Every one of these is runway.

The best leader you ever had gave it to you. Now it's your turn.

THREE THINGS FOR THIS WEEK

1. Give someone runway.
2. Hold one standard out loud.
3. Guard your own tank.

I AM SECOND

I am not the river.
I am the banks.

ONE QUESTION FOR THE WEEK

Who did I make better this week?

QUESTIONS

What questions do you have?

Scan for the slides, notes and more.

archetypeoriginal.com/mcdonald-county-leadership